

CodeAlpha — Phishing Awareness Training

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A concise, practical introduction to recognizing and preventing phishing for interns and general employees.



What is Phishing?

Phishing is a cyberattack that deceives users into revealing sensitive information by impersonating trusted parties. Commonly targeted data includes usernames, passwords, banking details, and personal information.

How it's delivered

Fake emails, cloned websites, SMS, voice messages, or social platforms designed to look legitimate.

Attacker goal

Credential theft, financial fraud, unauthorized access, or installing malware.



Types of Phishing



Email Phishing

Mass emails that impersonate familiar brands to harvest credentials or deliver malicious links/attachments.



Spear Phishing

Highly targeted messages tailored using personal or company information to increase credibility.



Whaling

Attacks aimed at high-value targets such as executives — often financial or legal in tone.



Smishing & Vishing

Smishing: SMS-based phishing.
Vishing: voice calls pretending to be banks, IT, or vendors to extract information.

Social Engineering: Manipulating Trust

Social engineering exploits human psychology rather than technical vulnerabilities. Attackers create believable stories that prompt action.



Impersonation

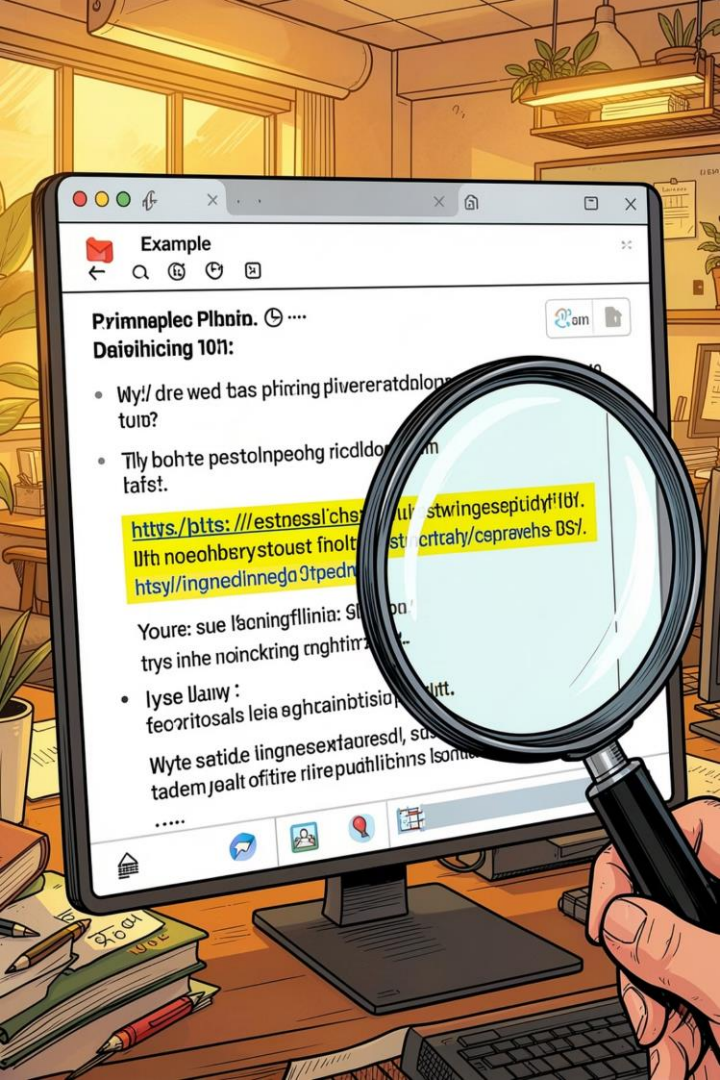
Posing as IT, a vendor, or a coworker to request credentials or access.

Urgency & Fear

Creating time pressure or threats to push quick, unverified action.

Fake Rewards

Promising prizes or opportunities to lure clicks and data submission.

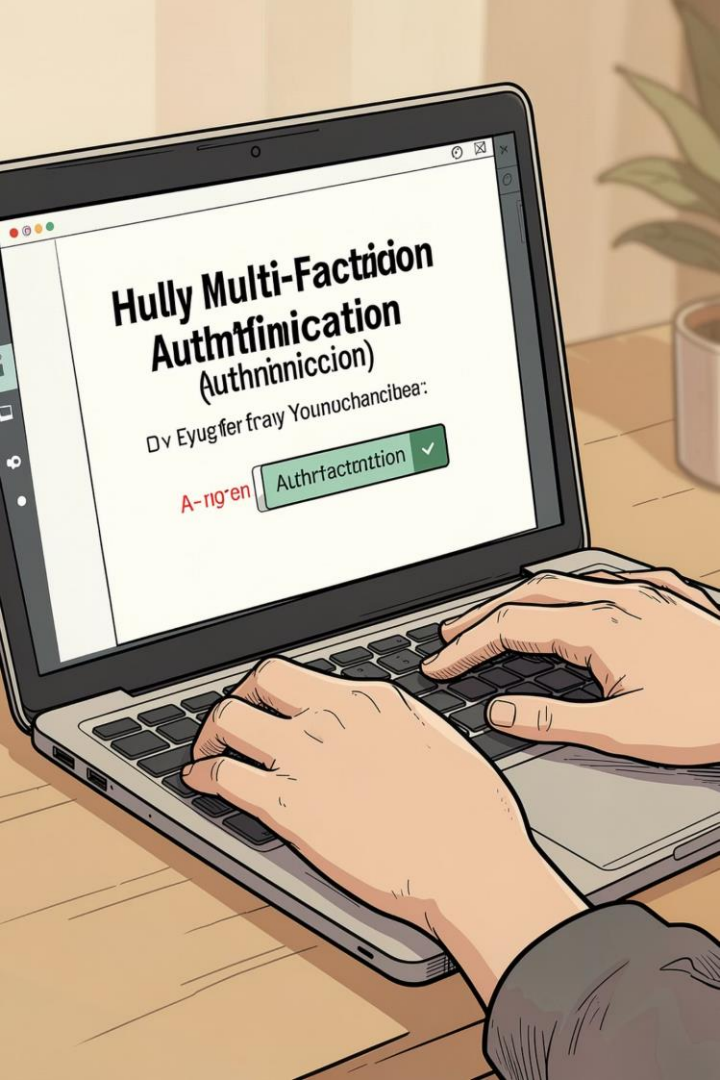


Phishing Email Example – Warning Signs

- Unknown or slightly altered sender address (look beyond display name)
- Suspicious links — hover to inspect the real URL before clicking
- Urgent requests for credentials, payments, or confidential files
- Grammar, spelling errors, or unexpected attachments
- Requests to bypass normal procedures or ask for secrets



If unsure, stop and verify: contact sender by known channels (not via a reply to the suspicious message).



Prevention Tips – Quick Actions

Verify the sender

Check full email address and confirm via separate channels when requests seem unusual.

Inspect URLs

Hover links, confirm TLS (https), and avoid logging in through emailed links—navigate manually.

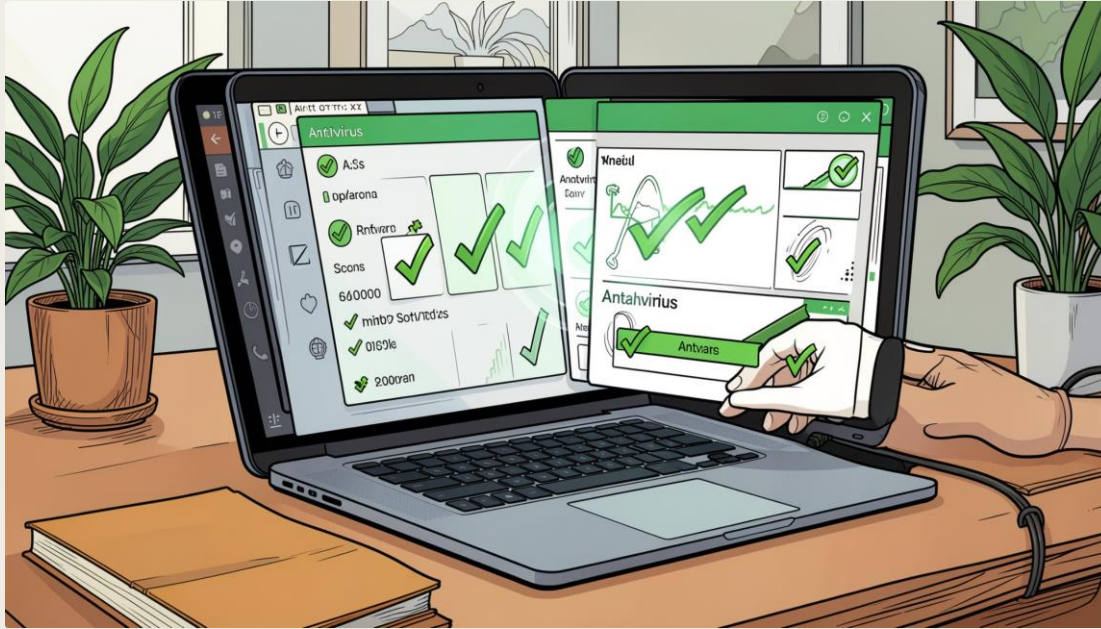
Don't click suspicious links

When in doubt, do not open attachments or follow links—scan attachments with antivirus first.

Use strong passwords & MFA

Create unique passwords and enable multi-factor authentication to block credential misuse.

Best Security Practices — Team Responsibilities



- Keep software and devices up to date — apply security patches promptly
- Use reputable antivirus and endpoint protection
- Attend regular security awareness training and simulated phishing exercises
- Backup important data and test restores periodically
- Report suspicious emails immediately to IT/security teams

 Reporting suspicious messages helps the whole organization — it enables rapid containment and learning.

Quick Quiz — Check Your Understanding

1. What is phishing?
2. Name two types of phishing attacks.
3. What is social engineering?
4. Why should users verify URLs before logging in?
5. What is Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and why use it?

Use these questions for a 5–7 minute group review or as short self-check prompts after the session.



Conclusion & Next Steps

Phishing remains a top attack vector, but awareness and consistent practices drastically reduce risk. Remember: verify, pause, and report.

Key Takeaways

Be skeptical of unexpected requests, inspect senders and links, use MFA, and report incidents fast.

Actions for You

Enable MFA, update devices, participate in drills, and forward suspicious emails to security@yourcompany.example.

Thank you — Questions? Contact the security team for support.

